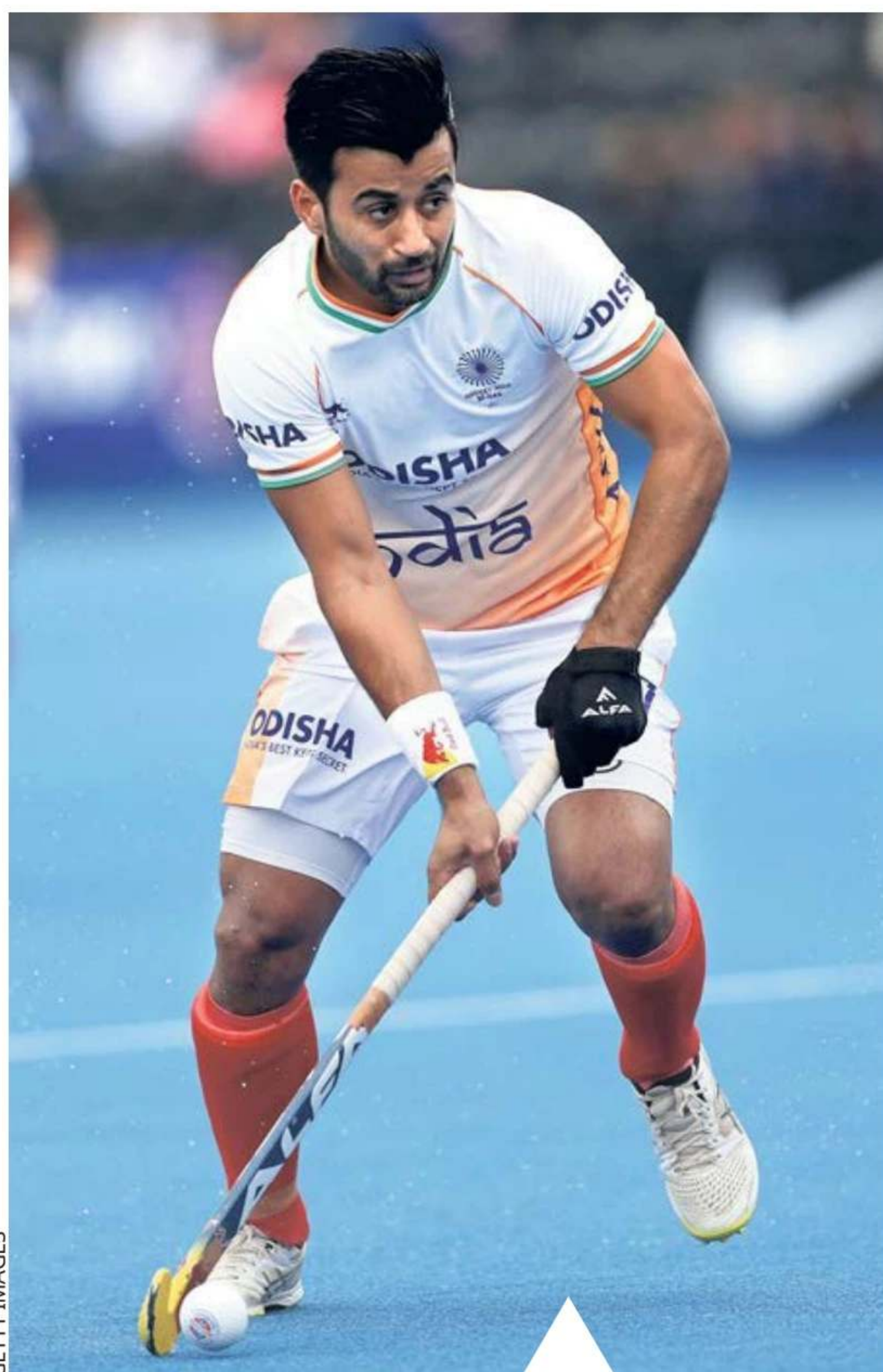




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Key player – **Manpreet Singh**

**₹42 lakh**

#### **Team Gonasika**

Team Gonasika has a strong Indian core in midfielder Manpreet Singh, forward Mandeep Singh, defender Birender Lakra, and goalkeeper Suraj Karkera. Forward Tom Boon's withdrawal will sting but the team has roped in exciting French forward Timothee Clement as his replacement.

Gonasika has as many as five players from the United Kingdom in its squad with Ollie Payne being a strong candidate for the goalkeeping spot.

The team has invested heavily in next generation of Indian stars, acquiring junior men's hockey team captain Amir Ali (₹34 lakh), forward Araijeet Singh Hundal (₹42 lakh), midfielder Vishnukant Singh (₹20 lakh), and defender Anmol Ekka (₹9.2 lakh), for a total outlay of ₹1.05 crore.



Key player – **Thierry Brinkman**

**₹38 lakh**

#### **Kalinga Lancers**

Defending champion Lancers is the only club returning from the previous iteration of the HIL. The squad is studded with international captains, including Australia's Aran Zalewski, the Netherlands' Thierry Brinkman, and Belgium's Arthur Van Doren.

The core is heavily European, featuring Brinkman, Enrique Gonzalez, and the Belgian trio of Van Doren, Antoine Kina, and Alexander Hendrickx. India goalkeeper Krishan Pathak provides security at the back, while Hendrickx will pose a big threat with his drag flicks. The Mark Hager-coached side will be a top contender for the title.

**Aashin Prasad**